

2. Add bones to the armature
3. Skin the mesh to the bones
4. Animate the armature by posing the bones

Adding an armature

Press Shift+A. From the Add, menu select Armature > Single Bone.

Entering Edit Mode

Switch over to Edit Mode. Every bone in the armature consists of three parts: root, tip and body.

Right-click the bone-tip and grab it using G and then pressing Z to restrict its translation to just the Z-axis. The bone-tip is moved to the top of the mushroom-stalk.

Extruding the Armature

The same we extruded before we need to extrude from the tip of the bone.

The Bones Context

Left-click on the Bones context button. In the 3D view rename the bone named Bone to stalk and Bone.OO1 to cap.

Creating the Hop

Similar to how your normal TV works animate, by showing 24 different frames per second, giving an illusion of movement and activity, Blender uses something called keyframes, more precisely a sequence of keyframes to create animations. Each keyframe has the object in a different pose. Blender smartly transitions between two keyframes by filling in the gaps or to put it in technical terms, interpolating.

Keyframe and the Hop

Take your mouse over to the Timeline and thrice press the Right-Arrow key to go directly to frame number four. Let the stalk bone remain selected, press S to scale and then for z-axis restriction press Z. Use the mouse to squish our mushroom and then accept the scaling.

From the Insert, Keyframe Menu activate the option Scaling.

Now straight to frame number eight and to clear off the scaling type Option-S.